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The bulkiest, most power hungry component of your computer, the monitor, has undergone a change of many sorts with the coming of the LCD versions. While the LCD technology is not new in itself (remember the LCD display on watches?), it was not perfected enough for monitors until quite recently. LCD monitors are very thin in comparison to their older cousins, the CRTs. They consume just about one third the power and offer a flicker free viewing experience. This makes them ideal for office use where energy conservation, space and of course reducing employee fatigue is a prime concern.

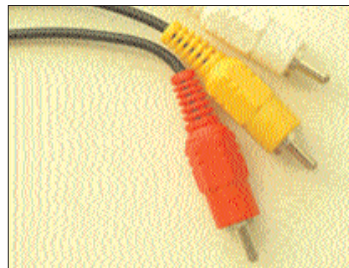
Video On Your Monitor

If you have just bought an LCD monitor for your home that has a composite or S-video input, here is how you can get to watch movies from your DVD player on it. DVD players provide an output through the composite, compo-



S-Video connector

nent or S-video ports. Get a suitable cable and connect it from the video out of the DVD / VCD player to the video in of the LCD monitor. Keep the monitor powered on with its power cable just as you normally would. If your monitor as well as the player supports S-video, it is better to use it rather than composite input for better



A composite video connector

picture clarity.

LCD monitors can offer hours of flicker free viewing that will make your eyes heave a sigh of relief. So far so good. But most LCD monitors are not suitable for viewing fast paced videos such as formula 1 racing or most music videos today. Thankfully, many manufacturers are making efforts to bring LCDs closer to CRTs in terms of viewing experience. Already there are LCD monitors with on-off time as low as 6 ms which is good enough for most movies.

INNOVATIONS! 3D On Your LCD Monitor

Making a device do more than just what it was originally intended for brings out some amazing innovations. One such innovation is a plastic strip that can be clipped onto LCD monitors to render 3D viewing experience. A 3D kit for laptops and LCD monitors includes a strip of plastic that has special optical properties and software, which creates perspective views that makes normal 2D images appear as 3D.

The plastic strip that is used consists of small polarised prisms that diverts light from alternate pixels in opposite directions. For example, all even pixels would be diverted to the left eye and odd pixels to the right. This gives a feeling of being surrounded by the object from the sides, rather than simply viewing it straight on. The software that is bundled with the kit creates certain number of perspectives (viewing angles) horizontally and vertically. Accordingly the add-on plastic sheet will contain polarized areas such that each perspective is rendered in a slightly different angle.

Thus if we have 8 horizontal and 4 vertical views on a standard 1024 X 768 resolution, a 3D of 128 X 192 (1024/8 and 768/4) resolution. The software generates display such that every 8th horizontal pixel is same and similarly every 4th vertical pixel is same.

These 3D kits are not yet available commonly in India, but it is only a matter of time before you can pick one up from your neighborhood store.

Manufacturers like Sharp are making LCDs with inbuilt 3D capability. Another innovation is that of the switching viewing angle developed by Sharp. There is an on/off control by which you can narrow or broaden the viewing angle.

Using ClearType Fonts In Windows XP

By turning on ClearType in Windows XP, you can make your text look smoother and more pleasing to the eye. This is more noticeable with LCD monitors than with CRTs. To enable ClearType, just right-click on the Desktop, choose Properties > Advanced > Effects, and check "Use the following method to smooth edges...". In the drop-down menu, choose "ClearType." For more fine tuning, download the Microsoft ClearType PowerToy from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/powertoys/xppowertoys.msp. This application shows you a bunch of screens, and you select which one appears best—thus ensuring you're seeing what you want to see!

Samsung SyncMaster TFT-LCD PC Monitors

The remarkable combination of exceptional performance & innovative design



640N (38.1cm)

740N (43.1cm)